

OVERVIEW OF THE YOUTH STATEMENT

This Statement provides key policy recommendations - called demands - from young people to U.S. policymakers and implementers. These demands are presented to various offices of the U.S. government, U.S. climate negotiators, and is incorporated into YOUNGO's Global Youth Statement, which aims to influence decisions at COP. It starts with a Preamble that leads into young peoples' top demands on policies and practices to advance action on mitigation, adaptation, and the just transition.

Using the NYS in Your Advocacy

The National Youth Statement provides a **unified framework that young people can bring directly into conversations with elected officials, civil servants, and community leaders.** In meetings with local, state, or federal representatives, it gives credibility by showing that the demands are not just individual opinions but a nationally endorsed youth position.

The National Youth Statement gives each delegate and reader a purpose to carry forward in their own community. **At the local and state level, delegates can take key demands from the statement and bring them directly to School Boards, City Councils, and State Legislatures.** In this way, we can turn our national priorities into concrete action. This might mean organizing a campaign for renewable energy in schools, testifying about just transition policies in a statehouse hearing, or leading workshops that connect community needs to the broader national vision. In this way, the statement becomes a bridge between collective youth voice and community leadership.

The statement is also an important tool in global climate spaces. At COP and UNFCCC subsidiary body meetings, it **represents the U.S. youth contribution to worldwide negotiations.** Sharing it with other countries' youth delegations helps identify common priorities. By connecting the National Youth Statement with YOUNGO and other international youth platforms, U.S. youth can amplify our demands abroad.